

Designing in India (Part 2)

Independent Design Houses: One-Stop Shops For Global Clients

Designs made in India are at the heart of many a successful product. India design centres and independent design houses are churning out innovative designs and intellectual property for their parent companies and/or clients—and fuelling success, whatever be the odds

■ JANANI GOPALAKRISHNAN VIKRAM
WITH INPUTS FROM JESUS MILTON
ROUSSEAU S.

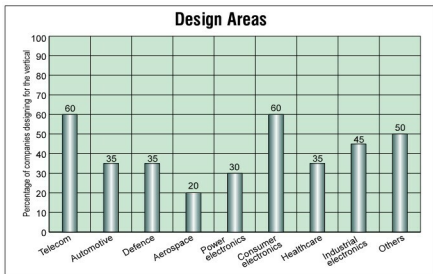
Success is being defined and designed in India by captive India design centres (IDCs) and independent design houses (IDHs), each working at a different scale and fuelling each other in the design ecosystem.

In Part 1 of this article published last month, we saw how IDCs of global companies were doing great work for their parent companies and clients, and growing at a steady pace.

In this concluding part, we look at IDHs—another category of designers. IDHs create designs and intellectual property (IP) for multiple clients, lev-

Companies surveyed

1. 4Semi Technology India
2. Acceptable Electronics
3. BPL Techno Vision
4. Dexcel Electronics Designs
5. Educ Micro Research, Systems Aids
6. Infochips
7. Indrion
8. Inforce Computing (India)
9. Infotech Enterprises
10. iWave Systems Technologies
11. Mandate Chips and Circuits
12. Martin's Electronic Devices & Instruments (MED)
13. MindTree
14. Saankhya Labs
15. System Aids
16. Tachyon Technologies
17. Verismo Networks
18. Whizchip Design Technologies
19. Wipro Technologies
20. Wysine Technologies



eraging on their core competencies. Sometimes, these make and sell IP components independently. Sometimes, they create the designs commissioned by a client. At times, they work hand-in-hand with captive IDCs of one or more component-makers to, in turn, create end-products for their clients. In these and many other ways, they try to act as a one-stop shop for their clients' IP and design needs.

We studied a randomly chosen sample of 20 Indian IDHs to find out the challenges and opportunities ahead of them. Here is what we found.

Telecom and consumer electronics: Largest markets

Telecom and consumer electronics dominate the electronics designing field

in India, with more than half of the surveyed IDHs (60 per cent) designing for clients in these markets. These are followed by industrial electronics (45 per cent), automotive, defence and healthcare sectors (35 per cent each). Thirty per cent designed for power electronics and 20 per cent for aerospace.

Other flourishing areas of design are industrial automation, railways, power supplies, intelligent automation, smart grid, networking, information technology (IT) products, radio frequency (RF), thin clients and digital signage.

Catering to global and local clients

Majority of IDHs designed for both domestic and foreign customers. Only Mandate Chips had 100 per cent exports. Systems Aids, Acceptable